

The Starlight Archives • Story & Setting

READ THIS FIRST • EVIDENCE TABLE SETUP

WELCOME TO THE STARLIGHT ARCHIVES

Tonight, you have gathered for an exclusive after-hours meeting of the *Starlight Circle*—a secret society of writers, scholars, archivists, and insiders who hold special clearance inside the Starlight Archives. At 12:00 AM, the archives' most restricted vault was scheduled to open to reveal Catalog Item RB-1147: The Starlight Ledger.

THE LEAD-UP TO TONIGHT: Over the past week, the Curator (John) audited the archives' restricted movement logs and security archives. He discovered serious irregularities: unlogged entries into restricted areas, unauthorized access, defaced artifacts, and an embarrassing historical family scandal. John privately confronted multiple members, warning that his audit was complete and that every secret would be exposed during tonight's 12:00 AM presentation.

THE INCIDENT: Moments after guests gathered in the Main Reception Hall, the Curator entered clutching a coat sleeve tear and holding his arm in pain. Seconds later, in full view of everyone through the gallery archway, he reached out toward Display Case RB-1147, touched its brass lock handle, and dramatically collapsed to the floor—dead.

VICTIM PROFILE: JOHN (THE CURATOR)

Title / Role: Chief Curator, The Starlight Archives | **Status:** Deceased (Collapsed at Gallery Archway)

Known Evidence Found On / Near The Victim:

- **On His Person:** A coat sleeve tear and puncture wound on his left forearm from a fountain pen strike during an earlier altercation.
- **On His Desk:** A ceramic tea cup with saucer smelling of tea and concentrated bitter almond infusion.
- **On His Study Desk:** A sealed handwritten letter addressed to the members of the Starlight Circle regarding tonight's rare book exhibition.

Evidence Item 1: Access Log Terminal Record

ROUND 1 DROP • CENTRAL ACCESS CONTROL LOG

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STARLIGHT ARCHIVES CENTRAL ACCESS CONTROL — AUTOMATED LOG
DATE: OCTOBER 24 | TIME WINDOW: 23:30 — 23:59

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[23:30:12] MAIN ENTRANCE: C. Claire (Order Keeper) — CARD KEY #002 [LOGGED]
[23:32:45] MAIN ENTRANCE: S. Sarah (Nocturnal Photographer) — GUEST PASS
[LOGGED]
[23:35:00] GUEST CHECK-IN OPENED: Front Desk Console Active
(Georgia/Charlotte)
[23:40:15] MAIN ENTRANCE: General Guest Arrivals Check-In Active [LOGGED]
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[23:42:00] SYSTEM ALERT: Rare Books Gallery Main Doors — LOCKED / LOCKED
[23:44:18] SECURITY SENSOR #04 (Gallery Courtyard Window Sill):
>>> UNLOGGED MECHANICAL UNLATCH DETECTED <<<
>>> DURATION: 00:02:15 | ENTRY TYPE: UNLOGGED MECHANICAL BYPASS
(VAULT KEYWAY) <<<
[23:46:33] SECURITY SENSOR #04 (Gallery Courtyard Window Sill):
>>> LATCH SECURED / CLOSED <<<
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[23:50:00] GALLERY ARCHWAY: J. John (Curator) — MANUAL KEY ACCESS [LOGGED]
[23:51:10] CRITICAL ALERT: Motion Sensor Gallery Case RB-1147 Interrupted
[23:51:15] OCCUPANT COLLAPSE DETECTED — RARE BOOKS GALLERY ARCHWAY

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Evidence Items 2 & 3: Incident Dossier & Audit Notes

ROUND 1 DROP • SCENE FINDINGS

CONFIDENTIAL CASE FILE #2026-1024

Victim: John (The Curator) | **Incident Time:** 23:51:15 HRS | **Location:** Rare Books Gallery Archway

Scene Observations: The victim entered clutching a visible tear on his left coat sleeve and holding his forearm. He stepped to the gallery archway, touched the brass lock of Case RB-1147, and suffered immediate collapse.

Initial Physical Observations & Points of Inquiry:

- **Forearm Trauma:** Coat sleeve tear and forearm puncture wound from a fountain pen strike. Discarded vintage fountain pen recovered from hallway trash.
- **Study Desk:** One (1) full ceramic tea cup on desk smelling strongly of bitter almond and herbal infusion.
- **Gallery Archway:** Immediate collapse occurred upon physical contact with Case RB-1147's brass lock handle.

 CURATOR'S HANDWRITTEN AUDIT MEMO (OCTOBER 24)

"For seven days, I have conducted an exhaustive audit of the Starlight Archives. Standards of scholarly integrity have been severely compromised from within. Active inquiries under formal review:

- **Catalog Tampering:** Forged marginalia discovered in restricted folio volumes, and missing catalog index records unaccounted for in central filing.
- **Plagiarism & Leaks:** Substantial evidence of verbatim plagiarism in recent publications, leaked society proceedings, and unauthorized surveillance.
- **Access Breaches:** Unlogged holding movements, unauthorized tampering with display cases, and deliberate alterations to sealed historical family records.

Tonight at 12:00 AM, before the main exhibition commences, I will formally present these charges before the full gathering and revoke the credentials of every individual involved."

— J. Curator

Evidence Item 4: Key & Access

Authorization Register

ROUND 1 DROP • OPERATIONS & PRESERVATION

SECURITY LOGS

THE STARLIGHT ARCHIVES — MASTER KEY & FACILITY CLEARANCE REGISTER

ANNUAL AUDIT STATUS:
CURRENT

PASS ID	MEMBER / ROLE TITLE	PERIMETER & DOORS (RFID)	VAULTS & EXHIBIT CASES	ARCHITECTURAL BYPASS (MECH)	PRESERVATION LAB & HAZMAT
#000	Raelin (Keeper of Keys)	Level 4 (Departmental)	Rare Manuscript Cases	Master Brass Keyring	Full Chemical / CATCH
#001	John (Chief Curator - Deceased)	Level 5 (All Facility)	All Rare Vaults	Curator Master Bypass	Full Chemical / CATCH
#002	Claire (Order Keeper)	Level 4 (Admin & Offices)	Reading Rooms Only	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#003	Georgia (Archivist of Secrets)	Level 3 (Reception & Stacks)	Public Archive Stacks	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#004	Ruthanne (Library Darling)	Level 2 (Lounge & Stacks)	Reference Stacks	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#005	Charlotte (Rare Book Specialist)	Level 3 (Restoration Wing)	Holding Vaults & Prep	None (Electronic Only)	Full Chemical / CATCH
#007	Christina (Literary Debater)	Level 2 (Chamber & Stacks)	Debate Reading Stacks	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#008	Ellie (Puzzle Tinker)	Level 3 (Workshop & Halls)	Mechanical Lockers	Workshop Latches & Vents	Workshop Solvents (Basic)
#009	Brooklyn (Historical Publisher)	Level 2 (Microfilm & Stacks)	Historical Study Stacks	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#011	Lucy (Aesthetic Curator)	Level 2 (Gallery & Lighting)	Gallery Exhibit Cases	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#012	Maddie (Conservatory Reader)	Level 2 (Botanical Lounge)	Botanical Archives	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#014	Victoria (The Annotator)	Level 2 (Manuscript Study)	Special Collections Room	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#016	Hope (Literary Prodigy)	Level 1 (General Library)	Public Stacks Only	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#018	Sarah (Nocturnal Photographer)	Level 2 (Darkroom & Gates)	Viewing Balconies	Courtyard Garden Gates	Photo Darkroom Chemicals
#019	Kaitlin (Silent Strategist)	Level 1 (Study Carrels)	Private Carrels Only	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#021	Gianna (Amateur Sleuth)	Level 1 (General Library)	Public Reading Tables	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance
#022	Vale (Unfortunate Witness)	Level 1 (Main Hall)	Main Reception Only	None (Electronic Only)	No Hazmat Clearance

Evidence Item 9: Forensic Toxicology Report

ROUND 3 DROP • REGIONAL FORENSIC CRIME LAB

CRIME LAB BIOCHEMICAL ANALYSIS • STATUS: COMPLETED

CASE REF: STARLIGHT ARCHIVES INCIDENT | LAB FILE: #TOX-2026-881

1. Left Forearm Puncture & Sleeve Swab Analysis:

Swab analysis of the coat sleeve tear and forearm puncture wound revealed trace black fountain pen ink and non-toxic metal particles from a gold-plated pen nib.

>>> **TEST RESULT: 100% NON-TOXIC / NO POISON DETECTED.**

The puncture wound was caused by a mechanical strike from the fountain pen and was completely free of toxins or poisons.

2. Desk Tea Cup #5 Chemical Analysis:

Chemical testing of the liquid recovered from Tea Cup #5 confirmed lethal concentrations of dissolved botanical cyanide.

>>> **TEST RESULT: LETHAL POISON CONFIRMED IN TEA.**

Chemical analysis confirms the beverage contained a lethal dose of botanical cyanide/almond toxin.

3. Right Palm & Lock Swab Analysis:

Swab analysis of the victim's right palm and the brass lock handle of Display Case RB-1147 confirmed heavy concentrations of an organomercury-based archival preservation chemical—an Ultra Violet light reactive archival preservation chemical.

>>> **COMPOUND PROFILE:** Lethally toxic through dermal contact absorption.

Evidence Item 10: Curator's Private Letter

ROUND 3 DROP • FOLIO 5" × 7" FORMAT

THE STARLIGHT ARCHIVES

FROM THE DESK OF THE CURATOR

To the members of the Starlight Circle,

As we gather tonight, I must remind you that the privileges granted inside the Starlight Archives are sacred. We built this circle on trust. Recent audits reveal that someone has secretly manipulated the glass case of Item RB-1147 to mask their unlogged entry into the secure rare book repository.

Tonight, I will inspect the gallery lock before midnight.

If you were secretly hoping to cover tracks, you was mistaken.

Everything that was tampered with in the archives tonight will be brought to light before this gathering concludes.

— *The Curator*

Evidence Item 11: Hardware & Physical Trace Analysis Report

ROUND 3 DROP • REGIONAL CRIME LAB
FORENSIC PHYSICAL TRACE UNIT

CRIME LAB PHYSICAL TRACE & HARDWARE REPORT • STATUS: FINAL

CASE REF: STARLIGHT ARCHIVES INCIDENT | LAB FILE: #TRACE-2026-904

1. Recovery & Perimeter Trace Details:

- **Target Item:** Solid-brass master key ring stamped with institutional designation #000.
- **Recovery Location:** Exterior courtyard hedge perimeter, situated directly beneath the unlatched gallery window sill (found adjacent to the recovered camera lens cap).
- **Physical Condition:** Clean brass surface; heavy antique barrel with notched bit configuration. Latent fingerprint dusting inconclusive due to glove handling.

2. Microscopic Tumbler Striation Analysis:

- **Key Bit Examination:** High-magnification optical inspection of the key bit notches revealed fresh mechanical friction striations and minute brass shavings adhering to the primary ward cuts.
- **Tumbler Profile Cross-Reference:** Striation patterns along Key Bit #000 correspond directly to the double-flanged cylinder mechanics of the courtyard gallery window latch and the antique brass tumbler assembly of display case RB-1147.